Table 1: The lineage as measured, classified by what each comparison can support. P^- is the judged regression set (older model complies, newer refuses) on SORRY-Bench; k/n is re-opened over the regression set. Only the matched-scale rungs answer the research question; the rest are reported as breadth.

Comparison	Kind	$\lvert P^-\rvert$	k/n	Status
Adjacent rungs of the lineage run				
Llama 2-7B → 2-13B	within generation	18	15/16	size step, not a release
Llama 2-13B → 3-8B	scale confounded	3	3/3	newer model is smaller
Llama 3-8B → 3.1-8B	**matched scale**	49	23/49	**the anchor**
Llama 3.1-8B → 3.2-1B	scale confounded	12	5/11	8B → 1B
Llama 3.2-1B → 3.2-3B	within generation	13	8/12	size step, not a release
Post-hoc matched-scale pairs inside the same run (not pre-registered)				
Llama 2-7B → 3-8B	matched scale	—	5/6	post hoc, raw
Llama 2-7B → 3.1-8B	matched scale	—	13/23	post hoc, raw

1 How to read these results

Six models give thirty ordered pairs, and the temptation is to report all of them. Most would not answer the question. This study asks whether a *generational* safety fix is bound to wording, so a comparison is informative only when the two models differ by a release and not by capacity. Of the five adjacent rungs of the lineage, exactly one meets that condition.

What leads. The chapter leads with the **held-out run**: the pre-registered confirmatory replication of the anchor pair on a behaviour set drawn from a different source (Amendment 1 §A2). It re-opens 6/9 fixes, corrected RSR 0.765 [0.381, 1.000], McNemar $p = 0.031$, verdict *materially surface-bound* against the registered reference $\pi^* = 0.15$. It is the only result in this thesis that is confirmatory rather than exploratory, and it is small — nine resolved fixes — so it is reported with that denominator visible rather than as a headline percentage alone.

The **anchor run** follows, labelled exploratory: 23 of 47 fixes re-opened, corrected 0.551 [0.364, 0.738], on the one pair whose judge is calibrated against human labels (60 bundles: se 0.862, sp 0.968, $\kappa = 0.833$). It carries the detail — per-category breakdowns, the gate audit, the white-box intervention — because it is the only population where that detail is calibrated. It does not carry the inferential claim, because its analysis choices were made after seeing it.

The 7–8B chain. Read together, the three matched-scale comparisons form a chain at constant capacity: Llama 2-7B → 3-8B → 3.1-8B. Recovery is high at the early step (5/6) and lower at the later one (13/23, and 23/49 for the adjacent anchor rung). The reading that invites itself — that successive releases patch wording less and intent more — is *not* supported at these denominators: the first step rests on 5/6 fixes, the two later pairs were identified post hoc, and no calibration exists for either. The chain is reported because it is the right *shape* of evidence for the question, and its weakness is a sample-size statement, not a null result.

What is deliberately not reported. No RSR is pooled across the lineage rungs. Averaging a matched-scale comparison with rungs that place a smaller model in the "newer" role would produce a number with no referent: it would answer neither "does a release patch wording" nor "does capacity determine robustness". The per-rung figures in Table 1 are therefore the finest grain at which the lineage is discussed, and the breadth it buys is coverage of the release history, not statistical power. Pooling *across benchmarks within* the anchor pair is a different operation and is reported where it applies (45/82, corrected 0.622 [0.470, 0.775]).

Three confounds stated once. They apply to every figure that follows.

- **Capacity.** Four of five adjacent rungs change size as well as generation. Only the matched-scale comparisons separate the two.
- **Quantisation.** The served weights are not quantised uniformly across the lineage (Ollama defaults: Q4_0, Q4_K_M and Q8_0; Amendment 2 D7). The anchor pair itself spans Q4_0 → Q4_K_M. Re-screening the older model at matched Q4_K_M leaves the π^* verdict unchanged (corrected 0.527 against 0.578) but moves regression-set membership (Jaccard 0.67): the generational reading holds at the level of the verdict, not of the individual behaviour.
- **Judge error.** Every rate is the verdict of one calibrated LLM judge. Corrected figures apply the bundle-level Rogan–Gladen inversion with that calibration; raw figures are labelled raw. The one arm no judge in this study can correct is attack transfer, whose design-weighted sensitivity is 0.07.

Status labels used throughout. *Confirmatory* — pre-registered before the data existed, on the held-out run. *Exploratory* — everything else, including the anchor, whose deviations are recorded in Amendment 1 and whose later additions are recorded in Amendment 2. *Post hoc* — a comparison computed inside an existing run after the fact; excluded from every pooled figure. Where a figure is *raw* rather than corrected, the population has no human-labelled calibration of its own and none is transferred to it without saying so.

References